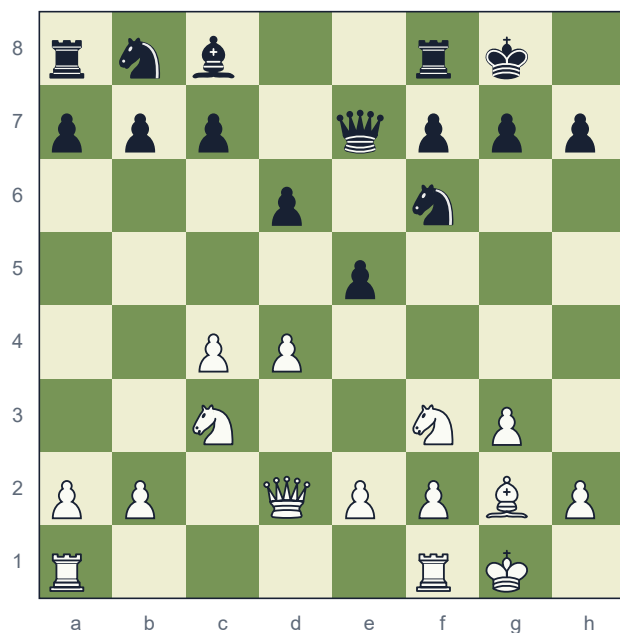


Bogo-Indian: meet the check with Bd2

1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 Bb4+ 4.Bd2

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use Bd2 to answer the check without committing the b1 knight. A kingside fianchetto often gives easy development and useful control of the center.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

Black may exchange the bishop, retreat it, or preserve it with ...a5. The unresolved c- and d-pawn tension matters more than the check itself.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

...Bxd2+ removes White's bishop; ...Qe7 prepares development without choosing the center; ...a5 keeps the bishop on b4 longer.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. The Bogo is available because you played Nf3 rather than Nc3.
2. A check is not necessarily a threat that requires a passive defense.
3. Recapture choices on d2 change your coordination and central plans.

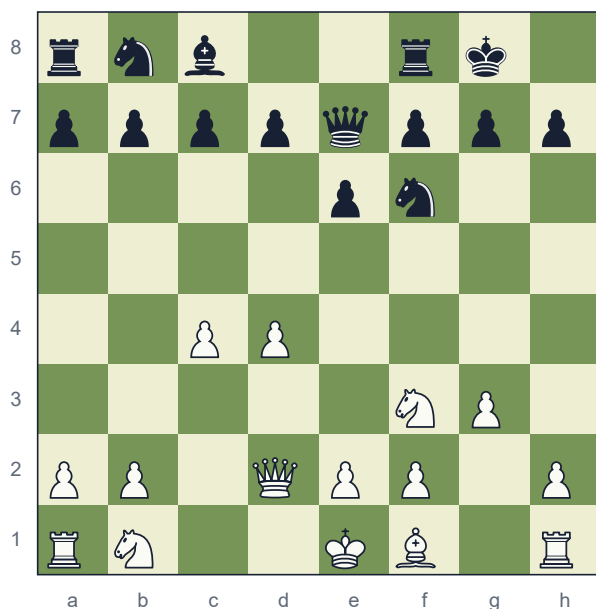
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main ...Qe7 setup

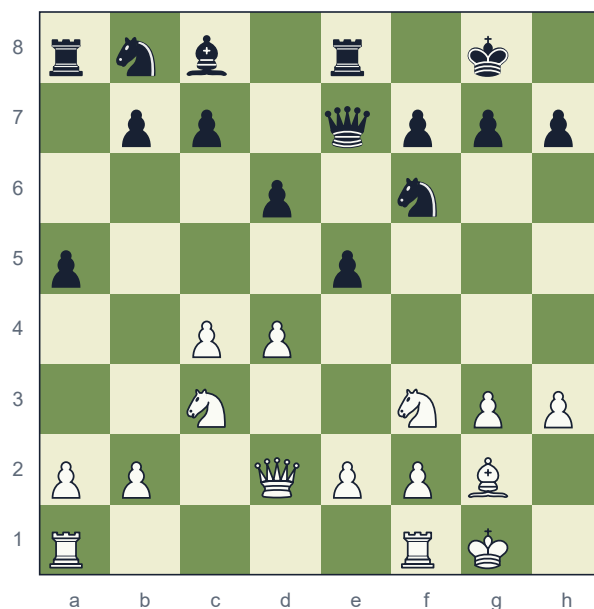
STUDY LINE 12-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Qe7 5. g3 Bxd2+ 6. Qxd2 O-O 7. Bg2 d6 8. Nc3 e5 9. O-O Re8 10. h3 a5

Selected anchor ends with 9. O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen recapture preserves the b1 knight's choice of square. g3 and Bg2 provide a compact developing scheme.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

If ...e5 closes the center after d5, improve pieces around the space advantage. If the tension remains, prepare a central exchange on favorable terms.

WATCH FOR

An early d5 may help Black maneuver knights if your pieces are not ready to use the extra space.

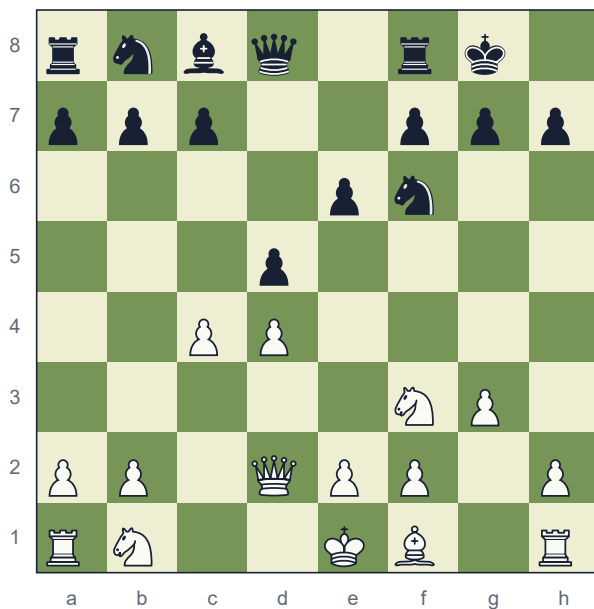
REMEMBER Answer the check and keep your development flexible.

02 Black exchanges immediately

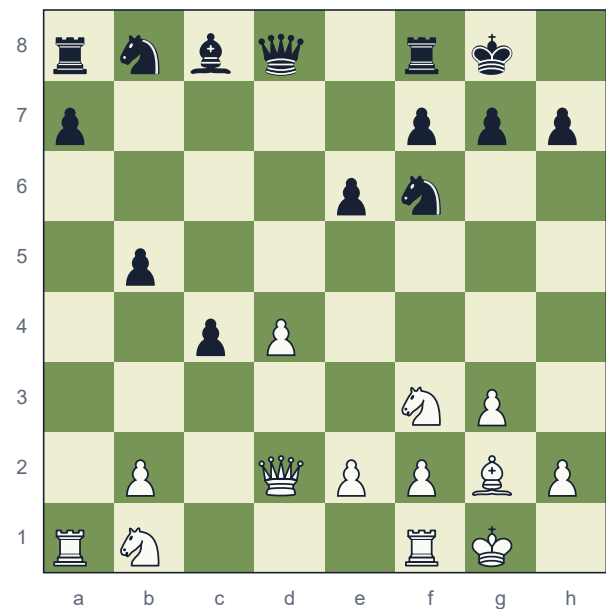
STUDY LINE 12-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Bxd2+ 5. Qxd2 d5 6. g3 O-O 7. Bg2 c6 8. O-O dxc4 9. a4 b5 10. axb5 cxb5

Selected anchor ends with 7. Bg2. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The check has led to an early bishop exchange. You can still use the fianchetto while keeping d4 and c4 in the center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Castle and develop Nc3. Pressure on the long diagonal can become relevant after central pawn exchanges.

WATCH FOR

Do not assume that the missing light-squared bishops make the entire position harmless; ...dxc4 and ...c5 remain important.

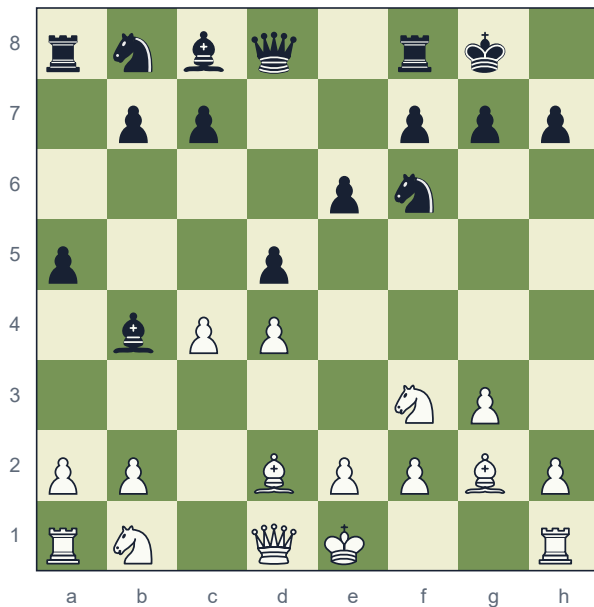
REMEMBER The center still needs attention after a simple exchange.

03 The ...a5 bishop retreat square

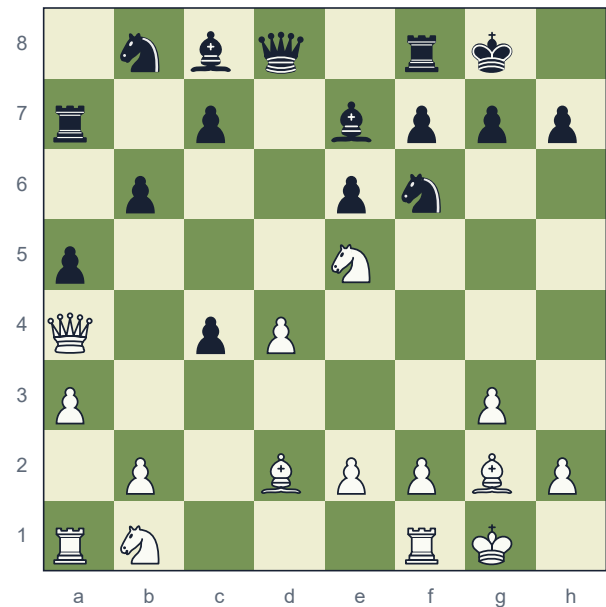
STUDY LINE 12-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 a5 5. g3 d5 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O dxc4 8. a3 Be7 9. Qa4 b6 10. Ne5 Ra7

Selected anchor ends with 7. O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black spends a tempo preserving the b4 bishop. White uses that time to finish kingside development.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Challenge the bishop with Nc3 or a3 only when the exchange or retreat benefits you. Inspect c4 and d4 before each pawn move.

WATCH FOR

a3 may merely induce a favorable exchange for Black if you are unprepared for the recapture.

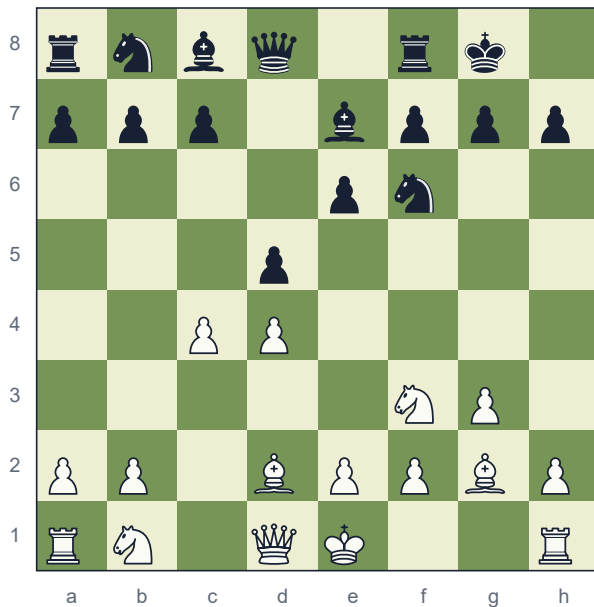
REMEMBER Develop while Black invests in bishop placement.

04 The bishop retreats to e7

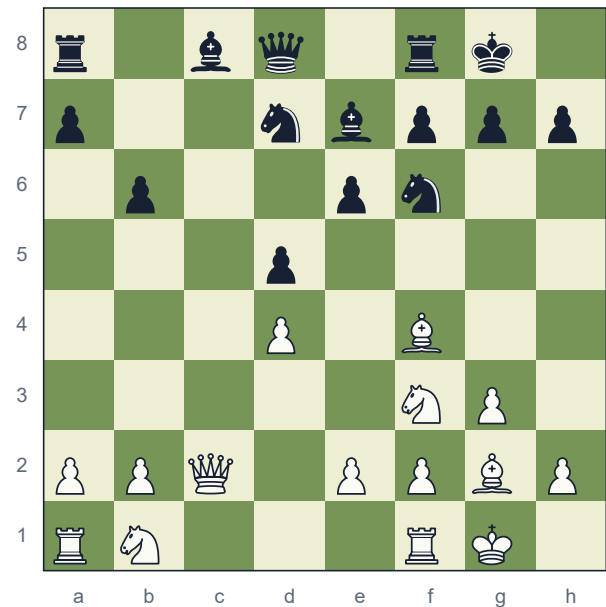
STUDY LINE 12-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Be7 5. g3 d5 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O Nbd7 8. Qc2 c6 9. Bf4 b6 10. cxd5 cxd5

Selected anchor ends with 7. O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black has spent a tempo on the bishop excursion. A calm developing plan is enough to use the extra freedom.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

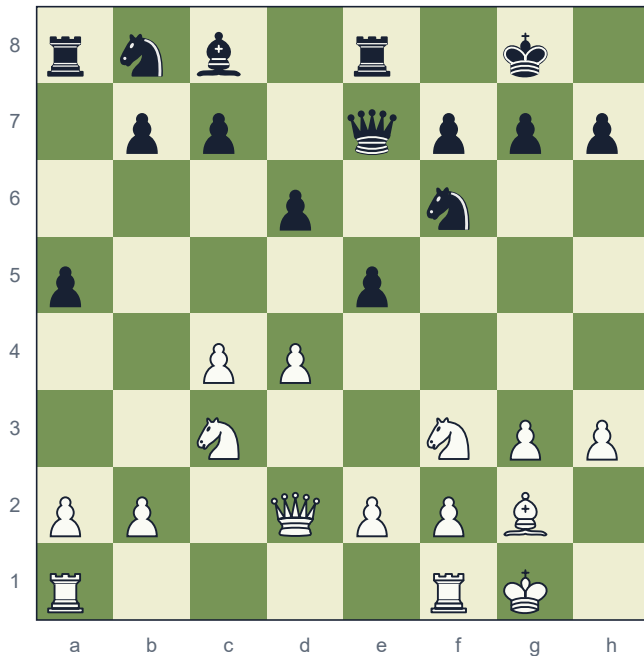
Prepare Nc3 and central pressure. Transpose to related fianchetto structures only when the bishop and queen placements match.

WATCH FOR

Do not invent a forced attack solely because Black lost a tempo.

REMEMBER Use time to improve coordination.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

Black may exchange the bishop, retreat it, or preserve it with ...a5. The unresolved c- and d-pawn tension matters more than the check itself.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

...Bxd2+ removes White's bishop; ...Qe7 prepares development without choosing the center; ...a5 keeps the bishop on b4 longer.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

If ...e5 closes the center after d5, improve pieces around the space advantage. If the tension remains, prepare a central exchange on favorable terms.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.